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The world as marketplace

Author(S): Bastian, Misty L.

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Section Title(S)

E. The Rapaciousness of Having Only One Tooth, or the Virtue of Juniority

Having tasted his "sweetness," the old herbalist offered her victim a bargain. She would allow him to "enjoy life" before his death—by making love to her. Douglas Amakiri's reaction to this proposition is extremely negative. Throughout the southeastern part of Nigeria, prohibitions against sexual intercourse between young men and elderly women are severe. In Igbo areas, this goes beyond *alu* and into the realm of *nso ani* (abomination against the earth). Elder women can joke—and often have joking relations with younger people—about sexual relations, but they are expected to lose interest in pursuing such matters after they are beyond child bearing age. The dismay felt by most southeastern people on this issue is echoed by the tabloid's use of this part of the  203 story as a subtitle "teaser."⁴⁴ These teasers are used to draw potential buyers in and often contain what is judged to be the most sensational aspects of any tabloid story. In the canny eyes of the tabloid copy editors, sexual relations between a young man and a woman in her seventies ranks, for sensationalist purposes, only below politicians using body parts for magic and enforced cannibalism.

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⁴⁴This teaser appears third, below the title of the article, after subtitles telling that politicians use the body parts and that one "lucky victim was offered human parts to eat." There is a distinct hierarchy of importance in the placement of these subtitles: crooked politic enforced cannibalism, wrongful sexuality, and finally the enormous price paid for heads.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



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